

KATELYN BRANDES

ASPIRING FINANCE AND TECH PROFESSIONAL

kqb22a@acu.edu | Dallas, TX

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Administration, Finance and Information Systems | Minor in IT Expected: December 2026
Abilene Christian University | Abilene, TX
Concentrations - Fintech and Analytics; Analytics | GPA 3.93

WORK EXPERIENCE

Operation Planning & Analysis Intern Summer 2026
Santander Bank

- Built a New Work Request form in Power Apps for business executives to submit requests directly to relationship managers and product managers, and cutting down repetitive back-and-forth emails
- Automated recurring PM tasks using Jira automations, including standardized feature documentation and pre-PI planning leader notifications, streamlining team workflows and centralizing information
- Designing a Power BI dashboard linking NWR form, story, and IT release date, giving RMs real-time visibility into IT deployment timelines and reducing status-check emails/meetings with PMs
- Shadowing a senior PM operating in an Agile Scrum environment, gaining exposure to how business and IT teams align around shared execution goals

Data Science Consultant Intern Spring 2026
USME

- Built an equipment rental demand forecasting model in Python, evaluating 6+ approaches (ARIMA, time series, ML, regression, exponential smoothing, quadratic seasonal) to identify the best-performing solution
- Quantified revenue impact by conducting a turndown cost analysis, translating model outputs into a concrete business case for stakeholders
- Collaborated with a 4-person team to deliver findings via a structured executive presentation

AI Analytics Consulting Spring 2025 – Spring 2026
ACU | Abilene, TX

- Led a team of 2 analysts across 2 client engagements, managing intake to delivery and achieving 100% on-time project completion
- Automated budget tracking for an SGA student organization using AI-generated Excel formulas, eliminating manual reporting errors and reducing cycle time
- Developed an AI-powered auto-grading system in Excel VBA, cutting grading time by 4 hours per exam

PROJECTS

Consulting Project for Pinecrest Cemetery Spring 2026
ACU

- Led two teams of four to diagnose operational inefficiencies for a family-owned cemetery operating entirely on paper since 1956, developing and presenting a modernization roadmap encompassing CRM implementation (HoneyBook), process workflow redesign, electronic payments, contract e-signatures, and electronic notarization — client confirmed intent to implement all recommendations
- Designed an AI-generated, dynamically updatable cemetery plot diagram categorizing each plot as available, sold, or buried, delivering real-time visual inventory management for the first time in the organization's history

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Office Specialist: Excel Associate Nov 2023 – Nov 2024
Competency in Networking by CompTIA May 2026

SKILLS

Technical Skills: ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini, NotebookLM, Copilot, GitHub, Jupyter Lab, Tableau, Power BI, Word, Power Point, Excel, Unity, n8n, Jira, Power Automate, Power Apps, Python, Scikit-Learn, R, C#, VBA, SQL
Soft Skills: Communication, reliability, problem-solving, team collaboration, consulting, & critical thinking

MEMBERSHIPS AND INVOLVEMENTS

Real Estate and Banking Society, member Fall 2023 – Present
Women Leading Finance, member Fall 2024 – Present
Study Abroad: Montevideo, Uruguay and Oxford, England May 2024 | Fall 2025
Volunteer: Beltway Church and St Aldates Fall - Spring 2025 | Fall 2025